fateful night. Sayyid Qāsim was in deep sleep without keeping a watch. They reached the fort, set ladders up, and got up on the gate, let the drawbridge down and, when around eighty good men in the mail were inside, the drowsy Sayyid Qāsim got the news of what was happening. Without wasting a moment, dozy with sleep, he got into his *kūnglāk* and then went out,with half a dozen of his men. Surprisingly, he delivered several blows and successfully drove the enemy out. He sent out the heads of beheaded troops to Babur as a present.

Despite setting a bad precedent after being carried away by sleep, his chasing away of troops with just half a dozen support indeed was an act of bravery (as narrated by Babur).

At the same time, the Khāns were occupied with the siege of Andijān, and they were kept on their toes by the garrison, who did not let them get nearer. The fight was on.

Babur Is Bidden into Akhsī

Things, which Babur had never imagined, were about to unfold. Shaikh Bāyazīd had begun to send people to Babur from Akhsī. Those people not only were well-wishing but also pressingly invited him to Akhsī. Perhaps, his intentions were clear. He wanted to separate Babur from the Khāns. Babur's removal from the list of their support would have suddenly brought a big dent. And certainly, if that was the truth, Taṃbal's brain must have been behind it. Babur sent out the hint of the occurrences to the Khāns.

And they said, 'Go! and by whatever means, lay hands on Shaikh Bāyazīd.'

Babur has asserted in the *Baburnama*, 'It was not my habit to cheat and play false; here above all places, when promises would have been made, how was I to break them?'[*]

And then a thought occurred to Babur that if they could get into Akhsī, they could detach brothers Shaikh Bāyazīd and Taṃbal by making the former take up Babur's side. In fact, Babur wanted to play the same ploy on the brother-duo that they wanted to play on him to separate him from the Khāns. With his aspirations set in the right order, Babur sent out a man to him. Good discussions took place and in return, he invited Babur into Akhsī. Finally, Babur went to meet him. Shaikh Bāyazīd, accompanied by Babur's younger brother, Nāṣir Mīrzā, came to see him. Babur's men were